

to the tradition of storytelling and the magic of fairy tales, the collection pays tribute to Jacob and Wilhelm Grimm, who popularised tales such as *Cinderella*, *Sleeping Beauty* and *Snow White*. Priced at over ₹32 lakh, the pen is shaped like a wooden wandering stick as a reference to the tradition of wandering storytellers. While the clip looks like a gnarly root upfront, when turned sideways it reveals the facial profile of the Brothers Grimm. The collection is limited to 86 fountain pens, a reference to the number of fairytales published in the first edition of their book.

If you are a serious pen collector, you of course must have a Caran d'Ache pen. And if it's an heirloom piece you are looking for, consider the Gothica. First released in China in 2006 by the Swiss manufacturer, the pen is limited to 1,140 pieces, representing the era that inspired the look of this pen. The six-sided body of the pen is made of rhodium-coated silver, which like diamonds and gold today, was once considered most desirable. The pen, inspired by gothic architecture, was priced at \$487,000 (₹3.98 crore) at launch. It

has since been discontinued making it more of a collector's item.

Then there's Montegrappa, one of Europe's oldest and most celebrated pen makers, which was the first Italian company to specialise in gold-nibbed fountain pens. As a result, they were a popular and reliable choice for soldiers writing home during World War I and the brand's most notable ambassadors included Ernest Hemingway. The brand continues to design limited-edition collections to fuel the passions of collectors and writers. Get yourself a pen from the 007 collection, limited to only 380 fountain pens with each individually numbered. Like James Bond's gadgets issued by MI6's Q Branch, there is more to the pens than meets the eye. A false barrel segment conceals a set of cufflinks that can be extracted and locked back into place as per need. Priced at €4,995 (₹4.35 lakh) the pen is available on the company website for worldwide shipping.

But it is their Viking collection available in both silver (€15,000, or ₹13 lakh) and gold (price on request) that has collectors excited. Made of pure silver or gold, the pen's cap is



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THE LUXURY PENS MARKET IS GROWING AT A CAGR OF 5 PER CENT AND IS EXPECTED TO BE WORTH \$3.27 BILLION BY 2028